

# Rachel Y. Kim

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*Social Science Researcher | Behavioral Insights, AI & Psychology | Humanitarian Technology*

Researcher and analyst with a background spanning cognitive science (USC, B.A., Summa Cum Laude) and social science (UCLA, M.S.S., GPA 4.0). Research interests center on empathy, prosocial behavior, social cooperation, and social cognition, with a growing focus on how AI can be designed and deployed to address human behavioral barriers in humanitarian, public health, and social impact contexts. Experienced in mixed-methods research, program evaluation, and building AI-assisted tools and workflows for non-technical teams.

## EDUCATION

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### University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

June 2025

*Master of Social Science (M.S.S.) — GPA: 4.0 | Social Sciences Departmental Award*

Relevant Coursework: Quantitative Data Analysis in Social Science, Qualitative Social Science Research Methods, Social Science Research and Perspectives, Social Psychology Research Methods

### University of Southern California (USC)

May 2022

*Bachelor of Arts, Cognitive Science — Summa Cum Laude | GPA: 3.97 | USC Summer Undergraduate Research Fund (2021)*

Relevant Coursework: Social Cognition, Cognitive Processes, Behavioral Neuroscience, Abnormal Psychology, Developmental Psychology, Sensation and Perception, Origins of the Mind, Origins and Evolution of Human Behavior, Philosophy of Mind, Design for User Experience

Study Abroad: John Cabot University, Rome, Italy (December 2018)

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Made New Foundation

July 2025 – Present

*Research and Evaluation Manager — Los Angeles, CA*

*Re-entry and justice-reform nonprofit serving youth, incarcerated, and formerly incarcerated individuals through VR-based programming*

- Built the organization's first formal research and evaluation infrastructure from the ground up — developing survey and observation protocols, scoring guides, data management systems, theories of change, logic models, and an outcome indicator library adapted from 9 validated psychometric tools across youth, prison, and re-entry programs
- Conducted mixed-methods data collection across all programs, including participant interviews, classroom and program observations, and survey administration, translating findings into internal reports, funder-facing communications, school district presentations, and program recommendations that informed curriculum adjustments and participant incentive planning
- Designed a reusable Claude-powered reporting workflow that converts summarized program data into structured first-draft evaluation reports, enabling a non-technical nonprofit team to translate survey findings into clear insights, recommendations, and partner-facing language — a direct application of AI to organizational capacity-building
- Built participant tracking and automated pre/post evaluation templates in Excel and Qualtrics, including calculations for domain means, Cohen's d effect sizes, and pre/post change scores; trained 10 facilitators on survey administration and observation protocols
- Expanded organizational capacity through website development, branding, event coordination, social media content, donor pitch materials, and testimonial video production

### Girls Inc. of Los Angeles

December 2024 – June 2025

*Graduate Research Intern — Los Angeles, CA*

- Evaluated a newly implemented Bold Unit curriculum by aligning academic literature, organizational theory of change, classroom implementation, and stakeholder priorities into a coherent assessment framework

- Designed qualitative protocols, conducted classroom observations and student interviews, and synthesized findings into data visualizations, presentations, and actionable recommendations for program leadership

### **UCLA Master of Social Science Program**

October 2024 – June 2025

*Program Administrative Assistant* — Los Angeles, CA

- Compiled a database of 30+ Student Affairs Officers to support program recruitment and outreach efforts
- Managed student lounge operations, inventory, and outreach material distribution; supported program workshops and liaised between students and the Program Director

## **RESEARCH EXPERIENCE**

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### **USC Social Learning and Choice Lab**

August 2020 – August 2024

*Undergraduate Research Assistant* — Los Angeles, CA

*PI: Leor Hackel, PhD*

- Investigated how wealth and generosity interact to shape one's ability to attract social capital in conditions of economic inequality, contributing to an ongoing Public Goods Game study on the social and cognitive motivations underlying cooperation
- Designed and implemented a real-time, multiplayer cooperative economic game end-to-end using Python and HTML/CSS on the oTree platform — providing hands-on experience building tools to study prosocial behavior and decision-making under uncertainty
- Conducted data analysis using R and contributed to manuscript preparation; recruited and facilitated 100+ participants via MTurk and Sona
- Led a targeted literature search on social influences on cooperation to develop the theoretical introduction for an upcoming publication; authored a comprehensive process documentation guide enabling future research assistants to replicate the full experimental workflow
- Received USC Summer Undergraduate Research Fund (2021)

### **USC Mind and Society Center: Culture and Self Lab**

October 2022 – August 2024

*Undergraduate Research Assistant* — Los Angeles, CA

*PI: Daphna Oyserman, PhD | Advisor: Amabel Jeon, MA, CPhil*

- Conducted two literature reviews examining how cultural identity and fluency shape information processing: (1) collectivism's effect on processing ambiguous information; (2) carry-over effects of cultural (dis)fluency on downstream cognition
- Assisted with IRB proposal development for a new study; piloted and cleaned Qualtrics survey data in preparation for analysis

### **USC Brain and Creativity Institute: Brain and Music Lab**

February 2020 – August 2021

*Undergraduate Research Assistant* — Los Angeles, CA

*PI: Assal Habibi, PhD*

- Investigated the impact of music listening and playing on brain development in children, with a focus on cognitive outcomes; supervised behavioral testing for local elementary school children to ensure data reliability
- Managed data collection, entry, and organization across Qualtrics and Redcap platforms

### **Inner Octaves Project**

May 2020 – September 2020

*Research Intern* — Los Angeles, CA

*Advisor: Tara Rose, PhD*

- Designed and conducted 15 virtual interviews with allied health professionals to produce an educational video on the underutilized role of music therapy in supporting older adults' mental health
- Examined the intersection of COVID-19, social justice movements, and mental health, exploring music therapy as a behavioral and psychological intervention

**USC Leonard Davis School of Gerontology: Emotion and Cognition Lab** January 2019 – May 2019  
*Undergraduate Research Assistant* — Los Angeles, CA

*PI: Mara Mather, PhD*

- Recruited 50+ participants and facilitated group sessions for a study on heart rate variability and stress response; logged and managed data using Qualtrics and Excel

**PROJECTS**

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**Prism: AI-Powered Behavioral Analysis Tool** 2026

Designed and built a public-facing, Claude-powered behavioral analysis tool that surfaces the empathic, cooperative, and cognitive dynamics driving human behavior in real-world social scenarios. Users submit a policy, program, or social problem; Prism draws from behavioral science, cognitive science, social psychology, and social science to analyze what is happening, why it persists, and what evidence-based levers could move the needle. Built with HTML, JavaScript, and the Anthropic API; deployed to GitHub Pages with a secure Vercel serverless proxy.

**Enhancing Global Crisis Communication via Generative AI Chatbots** 2024 – 2025

Graduate capstone examining how generative AI chatbots can improve humanitarian crisis communication by delivering personalized, context-sensitive guidance during moments of uncertainty. Analyzed cognitive barriers (information overload, mistrust, risk interpretation differences) and argued for an AI communication framework that adapts public-facing messaging to different audiences without sacrificing accuracy or ethical responsibility.

**Claude-Assisted Evaluation Reporting Workflow** 2025 – 2026

Designed a reusable AI-assisted workflow for nonprofit program evaluation: a structured prompt template that generates first-draft evaluation reports from pre/post program data, paired with an Excel template computing domain means, Cohen's d, and effect size interpretations across psychometric domains. Deployed at Made New Foundation to help a non-technical team produce research-quality outputs at scale.

**SKILLS**

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**AI & Technology:** Generative AI, Prompt Engineering, Claude API, AI-Assisted Workflow Development, API Integration

**Research Methods:** Mixed-Methods Research, Research Design, Program Evaluation, Survey Design & Administration, Field Observation, Qualitative Coding & Thematic Analysis, Quantitative Analysis & Effect Size Calculation, Pre/Post Assessment, Data Cleaning & Research Data Management, Participant Recruitment

**Software:** R, Qualtrics, Excel, Redcap, MTurk, Sona, Figma, Canva, Squarespace, Google Suite, Microsoft Office, GitHub, Git Version Control, GitHub Pages, Repository Management, Project Documentation, HTML/CSS, Vercel Serverless Functions, oTree, Heroku

**Languages:** Korean (Native) | Spanish (Elementary)

**CERTIFICATIONS**

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| AI Fluency: Framework and Foundations, Anthropic                                              | 2026 |
| Claude 101, Anthropic                                                                         | 2026 |
| GCP: Social and Behavioral Research Best Practices for Clinical Research, CITI (ID: 47764724) | 2022 |
| Social-Behavioral Human Subjects Research, CITI (ID: 47764723)                                | 2022 |

**HONORS & AWARDS**

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| Social Sciences Departmental Award — UCLA                        | 2024        |
| Latin Honors: Summa Cum Laude — USC                              | 2022        |
| Dean's List — USC Dornsife College of Letters, Arts and Sciences | 2019 – 2021 |

## **VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE**

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### **USC Science Outreach**

August 2019 – December 2021

*Science Educator*

- Designed and instructed weekly hands-on STEM lessons for elementary school students (grades 1-2); managed 10+ lesson plans per semester; facilitated remote learning during the pandemic

### **USC Wrigley Institute for Environmental Sustainability**

August 2019 – May 2021

*Social Outreach & Media Chair, Wrigley Ambassadors*

- Organized on-campus sustainability events, planned field trips, and led social media content creation to promote environmental engagement within the USC student community